



Bhopal Calling

Daring to test the waters outside her home turf, BJP's Sushma Swaraj will contest the Lok Sabha polls from Bhopal. Her name was approved at the party's national

Swaraj



executive meet in Nagpur. Bhopal has been an impregnable BJP citadel for two decades now.

by Ambresh Mishra

Cover Point

Following Mayawati's desire to induct popular names into her party, former cricketer Chetan Sharma has joined the BSP and has been declared a candidate from Haryana.



Sharma

Sharma met Mayawati and her MP S.C. Mishra in Lucknow and was asked to contest elections. by Subhash Mishra

KOLKATA | Playing Unsafe

Security seems to be the least of Mamata Banerjee's concerns these days. At the closing ceremony of the Kolkata Book Fair, the Trinamool Congress leader and MP decided to shake off her Z-category security. Not only did she buy the Book Fair tickets herself, but she also headed straight to the party stall, Jago Bangla, where she spent time surrounded by admirers as well as curious onlookers. Everyone but bodyguards it seemed. Such an indulgence isn't new to Banerjee who was stopped on the highway by policemen when she wanted to enter trouble-torn Lalgach

SUBIR HALDER



BANERJEE

which is dominated by tribals. Banerjee shouted back at the cops daring them to stop her and drove without any guard into the sensitive zone with policemen watching helplessly.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

MAHADEO SEN



MARANDI

RANCHI | Free Falling

Jharkhand's first chief minister Babulal Marandi could call himself a solitary reaper. After leaving the BJP in 2006, Marandi made an impressive beginning with as many as five party legislators who joined him, prompting independents to break free and bring down Arjun Munda's NDA government a year later. Marandi also went on to win the Koderma seat. But, that was perhaps his last hurrah. While his candidates have lost all subsequent by-elections, Marandi is now being deserted by friends. While two of his MLAs—Vishnu Bhaiya and Manohar Tekriwal—extended support to JMM, Ravindra Rai also bid adieu to Marandi to return to the BJP. It must be lonely at the...er...bottom.

by Amitabh Srivastava

KOLKATA | Off Side

Indian football seems to have many friendly helpers these days. Vikas Dhorasoo, former French international of Indian extraction made waves when he told the FIFA website that he wanted to be hands-on with FIFA's project to uplift Indian football. The All India Football Federation said they had no information about Dhorasoo's interest. by Elora Sen